

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 7

♥ Q 6 5 2

♦ 10 6 4

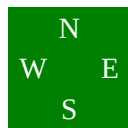
♣ 7 5

♠ A Q 4

♥ K 8 3

♦ K 9 5

♣ J 6 3 2



♠ 8 2

♥ J 10 9

♦ A J 7 2

♣ Q 10 9 8

♠ K 6 5 3

♥ A 7 4

♦ Q 8 3

♣ A K 4

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

3NT

1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ J

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♠ J, won by dummy's ♠ Q. The ♦ 5 is now played from dummy. What do you play?

Play the ♦ 2. Considering that South opened 1NT, he must have the ♦ Q for this play to make sense.

So if you put on your ♦ A, South will have TWO ♦ winners established. If instead you play low, then South cannot get a second ♦ trick and will have to look elsewhere for his ninth trick. As you can see, he is not going to be able to find it.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 4
 ♥ J 10 5 4
 ♦ 9 6 3
 ♣ J 10 9 3

♠ A 6

♥ K 9 3

♦ A Q J 7 4

♣ K Q 7



♠ 9 7 5 3

♥ Q

♦ K 10 5 2

♣ 8 6 5 4

♠ K Q J 8 2

♥ A 8 7 6 2

♦ 8

♣ A 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♦	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	3NT	Pass	4 ♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♥
Pass	6 ♥		
All Pass			
6 ♥ by South			
Lead: ♣ J			

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Your lead of the ♣ J was won by South with the ♣ A. South then played the ♥ 2 and you must decide whether to split your honors.

Play the ♥ 4, do not split your Honors.

South's bidding showed at least 5 ♥s, so assuming he holds both the ♥ A Q, it would be silly for him to finesse the ♥ 9 on the first trump play.

As it turns out, when you play low South calls for dummy's ♥ K, East's ♥ Q falls and you now have 2 trump tricks. If you had played the ♥ 10 you would have tossed away the setting trick.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 6 4

♥ K

♦ 7 6 4 2

♣ K Q 7 5

♠ K 7

♥ J 8 6 3 2

♦ K 5 3

♣ 10 4 2



♠ Q 9 8 3 2

♥ Q 4

♦ 10 9 8

♣ A 9 3

♠ A 5

♥ A 10 9 7 5

♦ A Q J

♣ J 8 6

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

4♥

1♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♣K

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣K, and you played the ♣9 to encourage him. He continued with the ♣Q, then a small card to your ♣A. You then exit with the ♦10, taken by dummy's ♦K.

Declarer then calls for the ♥J. Do you cover with your ♥Q or not?

Play the ♥4.

North has 5 ♥s and South must have at least 5. The reason you cover an Honor is that you hope to establish a lower card in either your hand or partner's hand. But your partner has one ♥ at the most so there is no hope of establishment.

Now that you have looked at the hands aren't you glad you didn't cover?

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 3
 ♥ J 10 8 5
 ♦ 10 6
 ♣ 9 7 6 4

♠ A 10 5

♥ Q 6 3

♦ 8 7 4 2

♣ J 8 5



♠ 8 6

♥ A K 7 2

♦ 9 5 3

♣ Q 10 3 2

♠ Q 9 7 4 2

♥ 9 4

♦ A K Q J

♣ A K

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ J			

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♥ J, covered by dummy's ♥ Q and won by East's ♥ K. East wins the ♥ A at the second trick and continues with a small ♥ ruffed by South.

South then plays the ♠ 4 from his hand. Do you play low? or play the ♠ J to force dummy's ♠ A?

Play the ♠ 3.

If South decides to finesse the ♠ 10 then you will still win the one ♠ trick which you are entitled to win.

However, with South holding the ♠ Q it would be very logical for him to go up with the ♠ A then lead back toward his ♠ Q, playing East for the ♠ K. If he plays this way you will get two tricks and defeat the contract.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5 3
 ♥ 9 8 7 2
 ♦ 8 6 5 3
 ♣ K 6

♠ K 7 4

♥ A J 10

♦ Q J 4

♣ Q J 10 7



♠ Q J 6 2

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 9 7 2

♣ 5 4 3

♠ A 10 8

♥ K Q 4

♦ A K 10

♣ A 9 8 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			2NT

Pass 6NT

All Pass

6NT by South

Lead: ♥9

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥9, taken by dummy's ♥10. The ♠4 is then played from dummy. Do you play low? or split your honors?

Play the ♠J (or ♠Q).

You should always make a point count check as soon as you see dummy. South's 2NT promises 20 or 21 points, North has 14 and you have 3; total = 37 or 38. Therefore West must have either 2 or 3 points. He cannot have two Jacks because you can see all four of them. Likewise he cannot have a Queen because you can see three of them and his ♥ lead (top of nothing) denied that Queen.

It follows that West **MUST** have a King, and it must be ♣s or ♦s since he has denied any ♥ Honor.

Since West will definitely win his King, you need to take one trick yourself, and the best way to do that is to split your Honors to establish one ♠ winner.

South has no defense to this, but if you had played low he would have played the ♠10 and made the slam.

Board 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 2

♥ 9 6 3 2

♦ 5 3

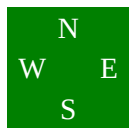
♣ K Q 4

♠ K J 5

♥ Q 7 4

♦ 10 7 2

♣ A J 9 5



♠ 7 6 3

♥ K J 10

♦ K J 9 6

♣ 10 7 2

♠ A Q 4

♥ A 8 5

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ 8 6 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ 10

twice as likely as ♣ K Q.

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♠ 10; low cards from North and East, won by South with the ♠ A.

South next plays the ♣ 3 and you must decide whether to split your ♣ K Q.

Play the ♣ 4.

If you split your Honors, playing the ♣ Q perhaps, dummy's ♣ A will take the trick and South will later play through your ♣ K toward dummy's ♣ J 9 5. Played in this way he will establish 3 ♣ winners (which he needs for the contract).

If you play low, he **MIGHT** finesse the ♣ J and again establish 3 ♣ winners. But South's correct play would be to put on dummy's ♣ 9, finessing West for the ♣ 10. This is because ♣ K 10 **or** ♣ Q 10 are

If he does play this way East will win the ♣ 10 and your ♣ K Q will get one more trick.